of the DIME paradigm are exploited to the fullest, we as a country will never be able to realize our full potential. The Armed Forces are always called in to do the 'firefighting', but perhaps, if we were to be part of the process, there would be no 'fire' in the first place.

Allocation of Assets

The point remains, though, that a ground-to-ground weapon system should never have been with the Air Force to begin with. It makes no sense to have the same system with two different Services performing essentially the same tasks. This had even been recorded in the minutes of a COCS meeting that the BrahMos should only be with the Army, but somewhere along the way, this had got overlooked. For the Army, the BrahMos is a major cutting-edge system, manned by the best. It is a full-time job, and an officer serves in a BrahMos Regiment for years and years till he rises in due course to command that Regiment. For the Air Force, it is a peripheral system; for them, the aircraft takes priority. It is precisely for this reason that Army officers are now being posted to BrahMos units of the Navy and Air Force. The better solution, however, would be to make all these units part of the Army.

There is similarly a need to review the allocation of all assets keeping in mind the changing character of war. Platforms that were specialized in bygone years are commonplace now. In the Army, we used to have special Missile Battalions, armed with anti-tank guided missiles. Now these missiles are with every Battalion and specialized missile units have been done away with. Take helicopters for instance: previously only with the Air Force, they are now with all three Services. Attack Helicopters (AH), which will always be in close support of

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